The difference in social-media strategies between the BJP and the Congress illustrates how message discipline works. One reason why the BJP's official social-media handles send out a far greater volume of content than the Congress handles is because, even though Modi was the dominant narrative, they put out content from a number of BJP leaders. As one social-media manager said, 'The Congress only largely retweets Rahul Gandhi.' Moreover, in terms of operational message discipline, while every Modi tweet would be retweeted by all the BJP ministers, most senior Congress leaders chose not to echo Rahul's 'chowkidar chor hai' line from their own social-media handles. Rahul himself did not retweet his sister Priyanka Gandhi, who was made in-charge for eastern UP, even once during the campaign. Jairam Ramesh tries to explain this by saying, 'In the public sphere, people are looking only for Rahul or Priyanka tweets. They are not looking for anyone else's tweets. In that sense, BJP is a flatter organisation than Congress. It [the Congress] is a command-and-control organisation, although in reality BJP is also command-and-control party. There is Modi and Shah and then there are others, but they are able to run it in this way.' At the end of the day, social-media strategies are reflective of the organisation they represent and can only be as strong as their backend.

Figure 7.7: BJP Won Almost All Seats Where It Replaced Its MPs *Total Seats Where BJP Replaced Sitting MP: 115*